FIELD FILE Y-001 // SPECIMEN OVERVIEW

SPECIMEN PROFILE / YELLOW DRAGON

DRAGONFRUIT

Y

YOUR LITTLE DRAGON STARTS HERE



WELCOME HOME, LITTLE DRAGON!

Your seedling was shared at The Fruitbat at CRFG-LA on November 21, 2026. This guide starts on giveaway day and stays with you through the seasons.

THE ORIGIN STORY

Grown from seeds saved from a store-bought yellow dragon fruit resembling Ecuador Palora. The exact variety is unverified. Dragonfruit Y is our project name, not a registered cultivar.

THREE RULES FOR A HAPPY DRAGON

_LIGHT

Bright, gentle light

O WARMTH

Protect from frost

WATER

Drain, never soak

FIRST THING TO CHECK

Make sure your cup has drainage holes. Place it in bright indirect light and keep it away from chilly nights or strong afternoon sun.

FIELD FILE Y-001 // FIRST SEVEN DAYS

YOUR FIRST WEEK

NOV 21 - NOV 28, 2026 / STARTER QUEST

01

FIND A GENTLE SPOT

A bright window or mild grow light is ideal. Avoid abruptly moving a sheltered seedling into direct afternoon sun.

02

CHECK THE TEMPERATURE

Aim for comfortable indoor warmth, roughly 65-85°F (18-29°C). Bring inside ahead of cold nights; avoid temperatures near 40°F (4°C) and frost.

03

WATER BY FEEL, NOT BY DATE

Check the soil. When its upper portion has begun to dry, water enough for some to drain out. Empty any saucer; never leave the cup sitting in water.

04

LET IT SETTLE

Keep it in its current cup unless there is a problem. Skip fertilizer for now. Slower growth after a move is normal.

THE SECRET: A DRY SURFACE IS NOT ALWAYS A DRY CUP.

FIELD FILE Y-001 // SEASONAL EVOLUTION

A YEAR WITH YOUR DRAGON

01 FIRST WINTER

LATE NOV - FEB

Keep warm, bright and protected. A gentle grow light for around 10-12 hours may help indoors. Water less often when growth slows; check the soil before every watering. A thermostat-controlled heat mat is optional if the room is chilly.

02 SPRING

MAR - MAY

As nights become reliably mild, gradually introduce morning sun over 1-2 weeks. If roots fill the cup, move to a slightly larger pot with drainage and airy, fast-draining mix.

03 SUMMER

JUN - SEP

Increase light gradually, but protect young stems from scorching afternoon sun. Check moisture more often in heat. Add a small stake or trellis as the stems lengthen.

04 AUTUMN

OCT - NOV

As growth slows, reduce watering and prepare a sheltered spot before cold nights. Repeat the winter protection routine.

FIELD FILE Y-001 // CONDITION SCANNER

READ YOUR DRAGON

Small changes are normal. These clues help you decide what to check before making big adjustments.

+

AERIAL ROOTS

Usually normal! Dragon fruit climb and may produce thin roots along their stems.

+

PALE OR BLEACHED PATCHES

Check for sudden strong sun, root stress, or watering problems. Shift to gentler light while you investigate.

+

LONG, THIN NEW GROWTH

Often a sign of insufficient light. Increase brightness gradually rather than moving straight into harsh sun.

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WRINKLED STEMS

Check both moisture and roots. Dry soil can cause dehydration, but damaged roots can also stop water uptake.

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SOFT, DARK OR MUSHY STEMS

Possible rot warning. Check drainage and roots promptly; avoid keeping soil constantly wet.

WHEN WILL IT FRUIT?

Seedlings can take years. Fruit traits and self-fertility are not guaranteed.

FIELD FILE Y-001 // COMMUNITY LINK

GROW TOGETHER

Each Dragonfruit Y is a little different. Your updates can help our community learn what happens next!

TWO WAYS TO SHARE

#DragonfruitY

The shared community hashtag

#DragonfruitY017

Example for a cup marked Y017 - use YOUR number.

YOUR DRAGON JOURNAL

FIRST WEEK

Show its new home

SPRING

Share new growth

SIX MONTHS

How tall is it?

SOMEDAY

A flower or fruit!

QUICK CARE CHECK

- [ ] Cup drains freely
- [ ] Bright light, slowly increased
- [ ] Cold and frost protection
- [ ] Soil checked before watering
- [ ] Support and larger pot when needed

MORE GROWING RESOURCES: THEFRUITBAT.ORG

Share only what you are comfortable making public. Participation is optional.